

So, I'm guessing that what you'd like to know now is whether there's anything we can do to stop this constant adaption, whether there is a big red stop button that we can press when our legs start to get wobbly. The good news is that there is – the bad news is that it's hard. If you're relying on external forces to let you know that you've finally made it, you will stay on that treadmill forever. Nobody is going to put a hand on your shoulder and tell you that you've done enough, that you have enough – you have to come to that realization for yourself.

It's not likely that any salary, or any amount of money in the bank, in savings or investments, is ever going to feel like enough – and not because you're greedy or insatiable, but because of the effects of hedonic adaption and the fact that you exist in a system where you will never run out of things to buy or ways to upgrade your lifestyle and comfort in accordance with your means. So, you have to start setting your own framework for fulfilment, and also accepting that sometimes achieving a goal doesn't feel like a lightning bolt of ecstasy, but something gentler and more subtle. Accept that you won't be able to alter that happiness set point in any meaningful way by getting more and more stuff, or seeing those numbers in your account inflate, and start looking at other ways to increase your happiness in smaller, everyday increments.

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